

Uploading Book PDFs to IngramSpark

via a Linux desktop (VNC) inside Google Cloud Shell

This is the full, self-contained walkthrough for uploading the print files to IngramSpark from a phone whose normal file picker doesn't work. You run a real Linux desktop with Firefox inside Google Cloud Shell (free), streamed to your phone's browser. The book files are pulled straight into that desktop from GitHub, so the phone is just a screen.

■ Cloud Shell wipes installed packages and the desktop between sessions, but files in your home folder (~) survive. If you come back later, re-run Part A steps 1–3, then your saved token (Part B) still works.

Part A — Start the Linux desktop + Firefox

1. On your phone, open <https://shell.cloud.google.com> and sign in. Wait for the black terminal to appear.
2. Install the desktop and a real Firefox (paste as one block):

```
sudo apt-get update -y && sudo apt-get install -y fluxbox tigervnc-standalone-server novnc websockify
cd ~ && rm -rf firefox firefox.tar.xz
wget --content-disposition -O firefox.tar.xz "https://download.mozilla.org/?product=firefox-latest&os=linux64&"
tar xf firefox.tar.xz
ls ~/firefox/firefox && echo "FIREFOX OK"
```

If Firefox later won't launch (missing libraries), run:

```
sudo apt-get install -y libgtk-3-0 libdbus-glib-1-2 libx11-xcb1
```

3. Start the GUI. The **exec fluxbox** line is critical — without it the VNC session exits instantly:

```
mkdir -p ~/.vnc
printf '#!/bin/sh\nxsetroot -solid grey 2>/dev/null\n%s/firefox/firefox &\nexec fluxbox\n' "$HOME" > ~/.vnc/xstartup
chmod +x ~/.vnc/xstartup
tigervncserver -kill :1 2>/dev/null
tigervncserver :1 -geometry 1280x800 -localhost no -SecurityTypes None --I-KNOW-THIS-IS-INSECURE
pkill websockify 2>/dev/null; sleep 1
websockify --web=/usr/share/novnc 8080 localhost:5901 >/tmp/novnc.log 2>&1 &
echo "started"
```

For a portrait phone screen, swap **-geometry 1280x800** for **-geometry 800x1280**.

4. Open the desktop: Cloud Shell toolbar (top-right) → **Web Preview** (monitor/eye icon, may be under a ■ overflow) → **Change port** → **8080** → **Change and Preview**. A new tab opens. If you see a directory listing or 404, add **/vnc.html** to that tab's URL. Tap **Connect** — you'll see a grey desktop with Firefox.
5. Hard to navigate on a phone? Open the small noVNC tab on the **left edge** → gear/Settings → **Scaling Mode** → **Local Scaling** (fits the whole desktop to your screen). A fullscreen button is there too.

Part B — Get the book files into Cloud Shell

You download the files into the desktop from GitHub (no native picker needed), then upload them to IngramSpark from Firefox.

1. Make a GitHub token (classic)

In your phone's normal browser, logged into GitHub: **Settings** → **Developer settings** → **Personal access tokens** → **Tokens (classic)** → **Generate new token (classic)** → tick the top-level **repo** box → **Generate** →

copy it (ghp_...).

■ A valid classic token is ghp_ + 36 chars = **40 characters total**. If it's a different length the paste grabbed extra/missing characters — that is the usual cause of **HTTP 401 Bad credentials**. Never paste a token into a chat/log; treat any token that lands in one as compromised and revoke it.

2. (Recommended) Save the token so you never re-paste it

Files in ~ survive between sessions. Save it once (never into a repo — GitHub auto-revokes committed tokens):

```
echo 'export GH_TOKEN=PASTE_YOUR_TOKEN_HERE' > ~/.github_token
chmod 600 ~/.github_token
```

Every future session, instead of pasting the token, just run:

```
source ~/.github_token
TOKEN=$GH_TOKEN
```

3. Sanity-check the token (do this before downloading)

```
curl -sL -o /dev/null -w "HTTP %{http_code}\n" -H "Authorization: token $TOKEN" \
  "https://api.github.com/repos/knightdx91-alt/The-Saeren-Chronicles"
```

200 = good, continue. **401** = bad/mistyped token (re-check length). **404** = token lacks access (use a classic token with the repo scope).

4. Download the files

Paste this. (Always clear ~/Downloads first — stale files caused upload failures.) These are the Book One barcode-fixed, press-ready files:

```
rm -f ~/Downloads/*
cd ~/Downloads
source ~/.github_token; TOKEN=$GH_TOKEN      # or: TOKEN=PASTE_YOUR_TOKEN_HERE
api="https://api.github.com/repos/knightdx91-alt/The-Saeren-Chronicles/contents"
get(){ curl -sL -H "Authorization: token $TOKEN" -H "Accept: application/vnd.github.raw" -o "$2" "$api/$1"; }

get "book/genesis/saeren-chronicles/delivery/cover/Saeren-Book-One-FULL-WRAP-r3-CMYK-noicc.pdf" cover.pdf
get "book/genesis/saeren-chronicles/delivery/production/Saeren-Chronicles-Book-One-6x9-interior-r14-PDFX1a.pdf" interior.pdf

echo "=== want real sizes + %PDF header, NOT ~112 bytes ==="
for f in cover.pdf interior.pdf; do printf "%-12s " "$f"; ls -lh "$f"|awk '{print $5}'|tr -d '\n'; printf " hd"
```

■ THE 112-BYTE FILE: if a file is ~112 bytes or its header prints {, the token is wrong and you downloaded a GitHub error. Run **cat ~/Downloads/cover.pdf** to read it, fix the token, re-run. A real file shows **%PDF** and a sensible size (cover ≈ 3.8 MB).

For other books, change the two paths. Book Two lives under book/genesis/saeren-chronicles-book-2/, Book Three under book/genesis/saeren-chronicles-book-3/. Use the **-CMYK-noicc** cover and the **-PDFX1a** (or **-GRAY-noicc**) interior.

Part C — Upload settings on IngramSpark

In the Cloud Shell Firefox, go to **ingramspark.com**, log in, open your title, and start the file upload. When the picker opens, choose files from **Home** → **Downloads**.

Cover: on the cover step choose **“my cover already includes a barcode”** (a.k.a. “I supply my own barcode”) so IngramSpark does NOT overlay its own white barcode box on top of ours. This matters — the corrected barcode

is baked into the file.

Interior: the 6×9 PDF (294 pages, Book One). Grayscale, no ICC.

ICC-profile warning: if it appears it is **non-blocking** — proceed. Our files are already profile-free, so it should stay quiet.

Cover size: 12.91 × 9.25 in, full-bleed, spine 0.661" (294pp cream). No white margins.

eBook is a separate format: its interior must be an **EPUB** (a PDF is rejected there).

■ Before approving for sale, order a printed proof and confirm the barcode scans and the interior text prints solid black (not gray).

Quick reference

Book One files (barcode-fixed, press-ready):

```
cover      : delivery/cover/Saeren-Book-One-FULL-WRAP-r3-CMYK-noicc.pdf
interior   : delivery/production/Saeren-Chronicles-Book-One-6x9-interior-r14-PDFX1a.pdf
```

Barcode verified: EAN-13 = 9798240990434 (ISBN 979-8-2409-9043-4), single barcode, no price add-on.

When done: revoke the GitHub token if it was ever exposed, and overwrite ~/.github_token with a fresh one for next time.